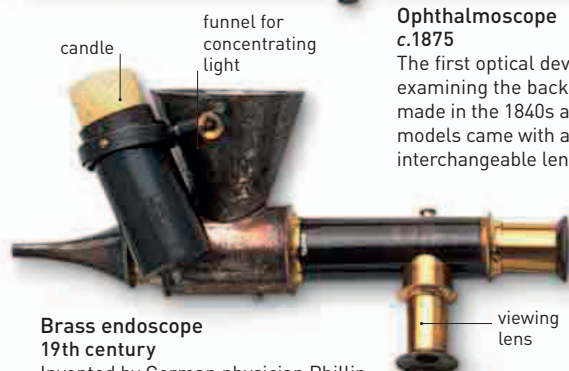
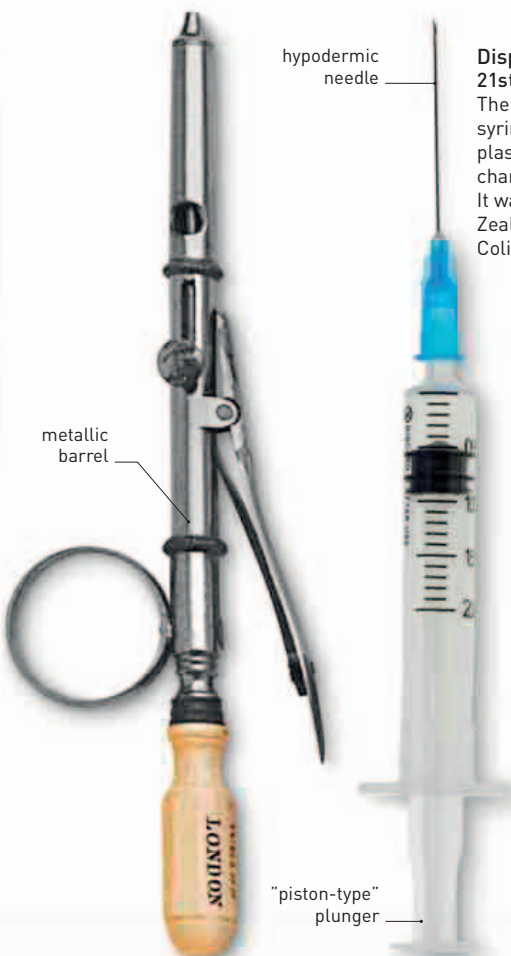




Ophthalmoscope
c.1875
The first optical devices for examining the back of the eye were made in the 1840s and 1850s. Early models came with a selection of interchangeable lenses.



Brass endoscope
19th century
Invented by German physician Phillip Bozzini in 1805, the first rudimentary endoscope was illuminated using a candle. An endoscope is used to "see inside" a patient.



Mechanical syringe
18th century
Piston-type syringes have been used since antiquity, but metallic non-plunger mechanical syringes were developed in the 1600s and 1700s, and used for extracting fluids.

Disposable syringe
21st century
The modern disposable syringe—made from plastic—reduces the chance of cross-infection. It was patented by New Zealand pharmacist Colin Murdoch in 1956.



glass barrel

"piston-type" plunger

hollow needle

protective casing

Clinical glass thermometer
18th century
German physician Hermann Boerhaave began using glass thermometers in the 1700s. In 1866, British physician Thomas Allbutt designed a portable, 6 in (15 cm) clinical model.



reservoir of mercury

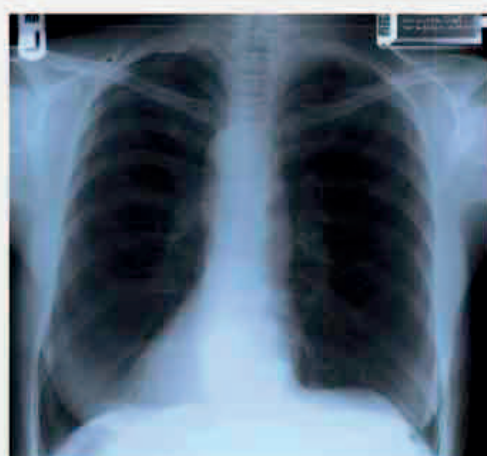
digital temperature display

Sphygmomanometer
1883
The first attempts to measure blood pressure were inaccurate, until Austrian physician Samuel Ritter von Basch invented the sphygmomanometer in 1876. In early models, pressure was measured by a water-filled bulb applied to the skin, but later ones used an inflatable cuff.

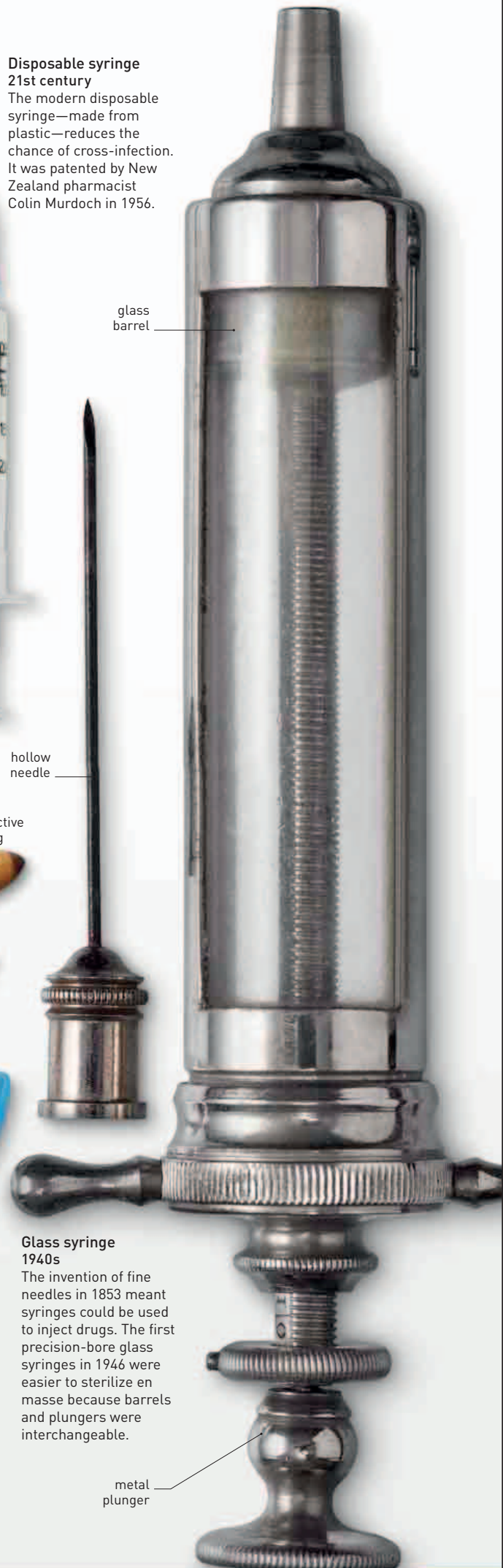


Digital thermometer
21st century
Invented in the 1950s, electronic thermometers measure body temperature with a far greater degree of accuracy and use an unambiguous digital display.

X-ray
20th century
German physicist Wilhelm Röntgen produced the first X-ray photograph—of his wife's hand—in 1895. Today, various scanning techniques are used to examine the interior of the body.



Glass syringe
1940s
The invention of fine needles in 1853 meant syringes could be used to inject drugs. The first precision-bore glass syringes in 1946 were easier to sterilize en masse because barrels and plungers were interchangeable.



metal plunger

rubber tubing